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FUNDAMENTAL & SUPPLEMENTARY RULES

(FR & SR)

General Rules • Travelling Allowance • DA, DR & HRA

Study Material

Inspector of Posts (IP) | PS Group 'B' Departmental Examinations

Updated as on June 2026

DISCLAIMER

This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view, for the use of candidates preparing for the LDCE Inspector of Posts (IP) and PS Group 'B' departmental examinations. Every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and to incorporate the latest amendments, notifications and Office Memoranda in force.

This document is a **study aid only**. It does not replace the statutory text. For any authoritative or official purpose, readers must always refer to the original Fundamental Rules, Supplementary Rules, the relevant Gazette notifications, and the Office Memoranda issued by the Ministry of Finance (Department of Expenditure), the Department of Personnel & Training (DoPT), and the Directorate of Estates.

While the rules and rates given here have been checked against primary sources current as on the date of compilation, government instructions change from time to time. *Dak Guru shall not be responsible for any loss or inconvenience arising from the use of this material.*

Currency of this Edition — Key Authorities Verified

Provision	Primary authority / status
HRA @ 30% / 20% / 10% (X/Y/Z)	DoE OM No. 2/5/2017-E.II(B) dated 07.07.2017, second step-up on DA crossing 50% (01.01.2024)
Allowance enhancement by 25%	Applicable on DA crossing 50% (CTG, mileage, DA on tour, conveyance, deputation duty allowance ceilings)
Deputation / Foreign Service	DoPT Consolidated Guidelines OM dated 28.03.2024
Premature retirement review	FR 56(j)/(l) read with Rule 42, CCS (Pension) Rules 2021
Travelling Allowance structure	MoF (DoE) OM No. 19030/1/2017-E.IV dated 13.07.2017 (7th CPC)

PART A — FUNDAMENTAL RULES (FR)

The **Fundamental Rules** are the foundation of the service conditions of Central Government servants whose pay is drawn from civil estimates. They govern pay, increments, leave principles, lien, transfer, foreign service, suspension and retirement. Together with the **Supplementary Rules** (which deal mainly with travelling allowance and procedural matters), they form the FR & SR code. The notes below explain each rule in plain language while keeping the exact statutory position intact.

Why some FR / SR numbers are not covered

You will notice gaps in the rule numbers (for example FR 21, FR 57–107, or long stretches of the SR series). These gaps are deliberate and fall into three categories:

- 1. Omitted / deleted in the rulebook itself.** The Government deleted the rule by amendment but kept the number vacant so that decades of cross-references in manuals, orders and case law are not disturbed. The official compilation prints the word “*Deleted*” against such numbers — e.g. **FR 21 and FR 22-C** are shown as deleted, and the bare numbers FR 25, 30, 32, 34, 38, 41 and 42 carry no operative text of their own.
- 2. Superseded by a separate set of rules.** A whole block of Fundamental Rules was lifted out and re-enacted as a standalone code. The largest block, **FR 58 to 104 (Leave)**, is now governed by the CCS (Leave) Rules, 1972, and **FR 105 to 107 (Joining Time)** by the CCS (Joining Time) Rules, 1979. These numbers stay vacant in the FR because the subject is dealt with elsewhere — the Joining Time rules are covered separately in Part B.
- 3. Not relevant for this examination.** A few live rules of a purely machinery or transitional nature, and large vacant stretches of the SR series (the SR numbers were never a continuous run — they were issued in clusters against the FR they supplement), have been left out or folded into a neighbouring rule to keep this study material focused on what is actually tested. The travelling-allowance SRs are reorganised by topic in **Part C** rather than presented by bare number.

Chapter I — Extent of Application

FR 1. Short Title and Commencement

These rules are called the **Fundamental Rules**. They came into force with effect from **1st January 1922**.

FR 2. Applicability

The rules apply to all Government servants whose pay is debitable to **civil estimates**, and to any other class of Government servants to which the President may, by general or special order, declare them applicable.

FR 3. Exceptions

These rules do **not** apply to Government servants whose conditions of service are governed by **Army or Marine Regulations**.

FR 6. Delegation of Powers

The Government may delegate powers to officers, including the power to make rules and to exercise other powers under these rules.

FR 7. Consultation with Ministry of Finance

No power may be exercised or delegated under these rules **except after consultation with the Ministry of Finance**.

FR 8. Power of Interpretation

The power of **interpreting** these rules is reserved to the **President**.

Chapter II – Definitions (FR 9)

FR 9 defines the technical terms used throughout the rules. The most important definitions for the examination are explained below. *Read the definitions of Pay, Lien, Duty, Fee, Honorarium and Foreign Service carefully — they are repeatedly tested.*

Key Definitions

(1) The Act — means the Government of India Act.

(1-A) Administrator — a person appointed by the President under Article 239 of the Constitution.

(1-B) Allotment — the grant of a licence to a Government servant to occupy a house (or part of a house) owned, leased or requisitioned by the Government, for use as a residence.

(4) Cadre — the strength of a service, or a part of a service, sanctioned as a separate unit.

(5) Compensatory Allowance — an allowance granted to meet personal expenditure necessitated by the special circumstances in which duty is performed. It includes Travelling Allowance but excludes a sumptuary allowance and the grant of free passage by sea to or from any place outside India.

(6) Duty — the following are included in, or treated as, duty:

- **(6)(a) Duty includes** — (i) service as a probationer or apprentice, provided such service is followed by confirmation; and (ii) joining time.
- **(6)(b) A Government servant may be treated as on duty** — (i) during a course of instruction or training in India; and (ii) in the case of a student (stipendiary or otherwise) entitled to be appointed to Government service on passing a course of training at a university, college or school in India, during the interval between satisfactory completion of the course and assumption of duties.

Government Decisions on “Duty”

- (a) The day of an obligatory departmental examination (e.g. Hindi examination, LDCE) is treated as duty.
- (b) An enforced halt may be treated as duty.
- (c) Time spent by a civil servant in the Territorial Army is treated as duty on training.
- (d) Refresher training of Section Officers is treated as duty.
- (e) Pre-appointment training is treated as duty for increments and qualifying service for pension, but NOT for MACP.
- (f) Participation in National / International sports events, and the pre-participation coaching camps, is treated as duty.
- (g) The period of waiting for posting orders on return from leave is treated as duty.

(6-A) Fee — a recurring or non-recurring payment to a Government servant from a source OTHER THAN the Consolidated Fund of India / a State / a Union Territory, whether paid directly or through the Government. It does NOT include:

- (a) unearned income such as income from property, dividends and interest on securities; and
- (b) income from literary, cultural, artistic, scientific or technological effort, and income from participation in sports as an amateur.

Examples of a fee: sale proceeds or royalties on a book, income from publishing a book, income from a patent.

(7) Foreign Service — service in which a Government servant draws pay, with the sanction of Government, from any source OTHER THAN the Consolidated Fund of India / a State / a Union Territory.

(9) Honorarium — a recurring or non-recurring payment granted to a Government servant FROM the Consolidated Fund of India / a State / a Union Territory, as remuneration for special work of an occasional nature. OTA, overtime pay and extra-duty allowance are treated as recurring honoraria.

(10) Joining Time — the time allowed to a Government servant to join a new post, or to travel to or from a station to which a posting has been made.

(12) Leave Salary — the monthly amount paid by Government to a Government servant on leave.

(13) Lien — the title of a Government servant to hold, on a regular basis, a post (including a tenure post) to which an appointment has been made on a regular basis and on which probation is not applicable. The lien represents only the RIGHT / TITLE to hold a regular post.

(14) Local Fund — (a) revenues administered by bodies which, by law or rule having the force of law, come under the control of Government; and (b) the revenues of any body specially notified by the President as such.

(17) Ministerial Servant — a Government servant of a subordinate service whose duties are entirely clerical, and any other class of servant specially defined as such by general or special order of the Central Government.

(18) Month — a calendar month.

(19) Officiate — a Government servant officiates in a post when he performs the duties of a post on which another person holds a lien.

(20) Overseas Pay — pay granted to a Government servant in consideration of the fact that service is being rendered in a country other than the country of his domicile.

(21) Pay — the amount drawn monthly by a Government servant as:

- (a)(i) the basic pay (other than special pay or pay in an officiating capacity);
- (a)(ii) overseas pay, special pay and personal pay; and
- (a)(iii) any other emoluments specially classed as pay by the President.

Non-Practising Allowance (NPA) to medical posts is 20% of basic pay.

Basic pay plus NPA must not exceed the pay at Cabinet Secretary level, i.e. Rs. 2,37,500.

(22) Permanent Post — a post carrying a definite rate of pay sanctioned without limit of time.

(23) Personal Pay — additional pay granted to a Government servant (a) to save him from a loss of substantive pay due to a revision of pay or a reduction of pay (otherwise than as a disciplinary measure); or (b) in exceptional circumstances, on other personal considerations.

(24) Presumptive Pay of a Post — the pay to which a Government servant would be entitled if he held the post substantively and performed its duties; it does not include special pay unless he discharges the work for which the special pay was sanctioned.

Illustration of Presumptive Pay

If an official is placed under suspension on a criminal charge, he draws a subsistence allowance (50% of last pay drawn) and earns no increment during suspension. If, after (say) 2 years, he is fully exonerated, he becomes eligible for full duty pay for those 2 years. The pay so re-computed for the past period is his presumptive pay for that period.

(25) Special Pay — an addition of the nature of pay to the emoluments of a post or a Government servant, granted for the specially arduous nature of the work or for additional work / responsibility.

(27) Subsistence Grant — a monthly grant made to a Government servant who is not in receipt of pay or leave salary.

(28) Substantive Pay — the pay (other than special pay, personal pay or emoluments classed as pay under FR 9(21)(a)(iii)) to which a Government servant is entitled on account of a post to which he has been appointed substantively — i.e. only the basic pay of the post.

(30) Temporary Post — a post carrying a definite rate of pay sanctioned for a limited time.

(30-A) Tenure Post — a permanent post which an individual Government servant may not hold for more than a limited period.

(31) Time-Scale Pay — pay rising from a minimum to a maximum within a level.

(32) Travelling Allowance — an allowance granted to cover the expenses of travelling in the interest of the public service; it includes allowances for the maintenance of conveyances, horses and tents.

Exam pointers – Definitions

Fee = money from OUTSIDE the Consolidated Fund; Honorarium = money FROM the Consolidated Fund. This is the single most-tested contrast.

Lien attaches only to a regular (substantive) post; it is a right/title, not the post itself.

NPA = 20% of basic pay; Basic + NPA capped at Rs. 2,37,500 (Cabinet Secretary level).

Chapter III – General Conditions of Service**FR 10. Medical Certificate of Health Essential for Appointment**

No person may be appointed in India to a post in Government service **without a medical certificate of health**. An entry regarding production of the fitness certificate on first appointment is made in the service book.

- The competent authority may exempt drawal of pay and allowances for a period **not exceeding two months** in respect of a new recruit pending the medical certificate.

FR 13. Retention of Lien

A Government servant retains a lien on a post:

- (a) while performing the duties of that post;
- (b) while on foreign service, or while holding a temporary post or officiating in another post;
- (c) during joining time on transfer to another post (the lien is carried over from the old post during transit);
- (d) while on leave; and
- (e) while under suspension.

Retention limits

Lien may be retained on appointment to another Central Government office / State Government for up to 2 years, extendable to 3 years in exceptional cases.

On deputation to developing countries of Asia, Africa and Latin America, the lien may be retained for an initial 2 years, extendable up to 5 years by the Ministry concerned.

Termination of Lien

- Lien is terminated on resignation / technical resignation.

- A Government servant's lien stands terminated on acquiring a lien on a permanent post outside the cadre on which he is borne.

No lien shall be retained where:

- (a) the Government servant has proceeded on immediate-absorption basis to a post or service; or
- (b) foreign service / deputation has continued beyond the maximum admissible time limit.

FR 15(a). Transfer of Government Servant

The President may transfer a Government servant from one post to another. A Government servant **shall not be transferred or appointed to officiate in a post carrying less pay** than the pay of the post on which he holds a lien, except (1) on account of inefficiency or misbehaviour, or (2) on his own written request.

FR 16. Subscription to Provident Fund and Other Funds

A Government servant may be required to subscribe to a Provident Fund, a family pension fund, or other similar fund, in accordance with such rules as the President may prescribe.

FR 17. Pay and Allowances Attached to the Post

FR 17(1) — Subject to any exceptions in these rules and to sub-rule (2), an officer begins to draw the pay and allowances attached to his tenure of a post from the date he assumes its duties, and ceases to draw them as soon as he ceases to discharge those duties.

- **Proviso:** an officer who is absent from duty **without any authority** is NOT entitled to any pay and allowances during the period of such absence.

FR 17(2) — the date from which a person recruited overseas begins to draw pay on first appointment is determined by the general or special orders of the authority appointing him.

FR 17-A. Unauthorised Absence

Unauthorised absence includes:

- (i) participation in a strike declared illegal under any law for the time being in force;
- (ii) participation in a strike without authority/permission; and
- (iii) an individual employee remaining absent without authority or deserting the post.

Such absence is **deemed to cause an interruption or break in service** unless otherwise decided by the competent authority for purposes such as LTC and eligibility to appear in departmental examinations.

FR 18. Maximum Period of Continuous Leave

Unless the President, in view of exceptional circumstances, otherwise determines, no Government servant shall be granted leave of any kind for a continuous period **exceeding five years**.

Note — Wilful absence not regularised

(1) Wilful absence from duty (even though not covered by grant of leave) does not entail loss of lien. The period not covered by leave is treated as “dies-non” for all purposes — increment, leave and pension.

(2) Where such absence stands singly (not in continuation of authorised leave), it constitutes an interruption of service for pension; unless the competent authority treats it as leave without allowances, the entire past service stands forfeited.

Chapter IV — Pay

FR 22(I). Initial Pay on Appointment to a Time-Scale Post

The initial pay of a Government servant appointed to a post on a time-scale of pay is regulated by the following clauses. Throughout, appointment must satisfy the eligibility conditions of the relevant Recruitment Rules.

Clause tree of FR 22(I)

FR 22(I)(a)(1) — where the appointment to the new post involves the assumption of duties and responsibilities of GREATER importance, the Government servant may opt (within one month of promotion/appointment) to have pay fixed either from the date of promotion, or initially at the stage of the new time-scale just above his lower-grade pay and re-fixed on the date of his next increment in the lower grade. (A proviso protects a person already at the maximum of the lower scale.)

FR 22(I)(a)(2) — where the appointment does NOT involve assumption of duties/responsibilities of greater importance, initial pay is the stage of the new time-scale equal to his old pay (or, if no such stage exists, the stage next above it). A further option for the date of fixation (date of appointment or date of increment in the old post) is available within one month.

FR 22(I)(a)(3) — where the appointment is made on the Government servant's OWN REQUEST under FR 15(a), and the maximum of the new time-scale is lower than his old pay, he draws that maximum as his initial pay.

FR 22(I)(b) — if the conditions in clause (a) are NOT fulfilled, initial pay is fixed at the minimum of the time-scale (subject to the pay-protection proviso below).

- **Proviso to (b):** a Government servant who has previously held — (1) the same post, or a post on the same / an identical time-scale [items (i)–(iii)], or (2) an identical tenure post — shall not have pay fixed below the pay he last drew, and counts that earlier service for increment. Service in a post under proviso (1)(iii) counts on reversion to the parent cadre subject to conditions (a), (b) and (c).

FR 22(II) — the President may specify posts OUTSIDE the ordinary line of service whose holders may be given officiating promotion in the cadre and granted the same pay they would have received on officiating promotion within the line.

Cross-reference: “substantive pay” and pay “classed as pay by the President” in this rule are read with **FR 9(21)(a)(iii)** and **FR 9(28)**.

Practical pay-fixation principles (7th CPC structure)

- **Rounding:** pay is rounded off to the nearest rupee in the pay matrix as prescribed (the old practice of rounding to the nearest Rs. 100 — ignoring less than Rs. 50 and rounding Rs. 50 and above up to Rs. 100 — applied under the earlier structure).
- **Option:** the option for pay fixation must be exercised within **one month** from the date of assumption of charge — the Government servant may opt to have pay fixed from the date of promotion or from the date of his next increment (DNI).
- **Two increment dates:** there are two annual increment dates — **1st July** and **1st January**.
- **From the date of promotion:** one increment is given and pay is placed at the equal or next cell of the relevant level.
- **From the DNI:** two increments are given on the old level pay and the pay is placed at the equal or next cell of the relevant level.
- **Qualifying period for an increment:** 6 months as on 1st January or 1st July, as the case may be.
- **Technical resignation:** past service counts for pay protection and for reckoning the minimum period for grant of the annual increment.

FR 23. Change of Pay of a Post

The holder of a post whose pay is changed is treated as if transferred to a new post on the new pay.

FR 24. Increment

An increment is ordinarily drawn as a matter of course unless it is **withheld**. When ordering the withholding of an increment, the authority must state the period of withholding and whether the postponement will also postpone future increments.

Withholding — “Next Increment” vs “One Increment”

Next Increment: all subsequent increments are withheld for the specified period.

One Increment: only one increment is withheld for the specified period.

FR 26. Service Counting for Increment on a Time Scale

- (a) all duty in a post on a time scale;
- (b) officiating / deputation service, in or out of India;
- (c) all kinds of leave except extraordinary leave (EOL);
- (d) EOL granted **(i)** on a medical certificate; **(ii)** otherwise than on a medical certificate, due to inability to join duty on account of civil commotion; or **(iii)** for prosecuting higher technical and scientific studies;
- (e) joining time when the lien is not suspended; and
- (f) time spent on pre-appointment training on stipend.

FR 27. Premature / Advance Increments

Subject to general or special orders of the President, an authority that has power to create a post in the same cadre on the same scale may grant a premature increment to a Government servant on a time scale of pay.

- **(1)** Stenographers — for qualifying shorthand at **100 or 120 w.p.m.**.
- **(2)** Special increment for sportspersons / referees / umpires / coaches achieving excellence: **National level — one increment; International level — two increments**; subject to a total of **5 increments** in the entire service.

FR 28. Transfer as a Penalty

This covers the transfer of a Government servant, as a penalty, from a higher to a lower grade or post.

FR 29. Penalty of Reduction to a Lower Stage

If a Government servant is reduced, as a penalty, to a lower stage in his time scale, the authority ordering the reduction must state the period for which it is effective and whether, on restoration, the period of reduction will postpone future increments and, if so, to what extent.

FR 29-A. Pay Regulation on Set-Aside or Modified Penalty Orders

Where a penalty of withholding of increment, or reduction to a lower service / grade / post / time scale / stage, is set aside or modified on appeal or review:

- (a) if set aside — the Government servant is given, for the period the order was in force, the difference between the pay he would have drawn and the pay actually drawn; and
- (b) if modified — the pay is regulated as if the modified order had been made in the first instance.

Note

The period between imposing the penalty and its being set aside / modified is counted for the purpose of increment.

FR 31(A). Erroneous Promotion or Appointment

Where a promotion or appointment is found to be erroneous, the pay of the Government servant is regulated in accordance with general or special orders issued by the President.

FR 35. Restriction of Officiating Pay

The Central Government may fix the pay of an officiating Government servant at an amount less than that otherwise admissible. The increase in basic pay on officiating appointment is **restricted to 12.5% of basic pay, subject to a maximum of Rs. 6,700 per month**. Any increase beyond this is treated as a substantial increase for the purposes of FR 35.

Authority

DoPT OM No. 1/4/2017-Estt.(Pay-I) dated 28.02.2019 (restriction of officiating pay under the 7th CPC structure).

FR 36. Acting Promotion (Officiating Arrangement)

The Central Government may, by general or special order, allow acting promotions in place of Government servants treated as on duty under FR 9(6)(b). **Example:** a Senior

Accountant working as AAO assumes the responsibilities of a higher post requiring greater responsibility and competence.

FR 37. Personal Pay

Unless the sanctioning authority orders otherwise, personal pay is reduced by any amount by which the recipient's pay is increased, and it ceases as soon as his pay is increased by an amount equal to his personal pay.

FR 39 & FR 40. Pay of Temporary Posts

- **FR 39** — where a temporary post is filled by a person who is NOT a Government servant.
- **FR 40** — where a temporary post is filled by a person who IS a Government servant.

Some Important Pay Provisions

(i) Bunching of stages — where, on revision of pay, Government servants drawing pay at two or more stages of the pre-revised structure get fixed at the same cell of the new pay matrix, one additional increment is given for every two stages bunched, and the Government servant drawing higher pay in the pre-revised structure is fixed at the next vertical cell of the applicable level.

(ii) Stepping up — stepping up of a senior's pay to that of a junior is done with effect from the date of promotion / appointment of the junior, subject to the following conditions:

- (a) both the junior and the senior belong to the same cadre and the posts to which they were promoted are identical in the same cadre;
- (b) the level in the pay matrix of the lower and the higher posts is identical; and
- (c) the anomaly is directly a result of the application of FR 22(I)(a)(1) read with Rule 13 of the CCS (RP) Rules, 2016.

The senior officer is entitled to the next increment on completion of the required qualifying service, with effect from the date of re-fixation of pay.

Chapter V — Additions to Pay

FR 44. Compensatory Allowance

Subject to the general rule that a compensatory allowance must be so regulated that it is not, on the whole, a source of profit to the recipient, the Central Government may grant such allowances and prescribe their amounts and conditions.

FR 45. Allotment of Government Accommodation

Government accommodation may be allotted to a Government servant under the Central Government for use as a residence.

FR 45-A. Assessment of Licence Fee

- (a) The capital cost of a Government-owned residence includes the cost / value of sanitary, water-supply and electric installations and fittings.
- (b) Licence fee = **6% per annum of capital cost**, OR an amount not exceeding **10% of the officer's monthly emoluments**, whichever is less; calculated per calendar month (annual licence fee ÷ 12).

Revised monthly licence-fee slabs (w.e.f. 1st July 2023):

Pay Level	Type	Living area (sq.m.)	Revised rate
1	I	Up to 30	Rs. 210
2 to 5	II	26.05 to 50	Rs. 440
6 to 8	III	44 to 65	Rs. 660
9 to 11	IV	59 to 91.5	Rs. 880

Government Decisions under FR 45-A

(a) Higher-class accommodation occupied — three times the licence fee of the higher accommodation.

(b) Licence fee recoverable from officers owning houses near their stations of posting:

Income from the residence	Rate of licence fee
Not exceeding Rs. 12,000	Normal licence fee
More than Rs. 12,000 but up to Rs. 20,000	Double licence fee
Exceeding Rs. 20,000	Triple licence fee

(c) Permissible period for retention of Government accommodation:

Event	Permissible retention period
Resignation, dismissal, removal, termination or unauthorised absence	1 month on normal licence fee
Retirement	6 months on normal licence fee

Event	Permissible retention period
Transfer / foreign service in India / temporary transfer / transfer outside India	2 months on normal licence fee, and up to 6 months on double licence fee
Death / missing of the Government servant	12 months on normal fee, and a further 12 months on normal fee if the family does not own a house at the place of posting
Study leave	Actual period of leave, or 24 months, whichever is earlier
Leave on medical ground / training	Full period of leave or training

- (d) An allottee under suspension is allotted accommodation as if the suspension had not taken place.
- (e) A vacation notice must be issued to allottees (or their families) at least **15 days** before expiry of the permissible retention period.
- (f) The normal licence fee for accommodation is revised every **3 years**.

FR 45-B. Licence Fee for Other Government Servants

For Government servants to whom FR 45-A does not apply, the licence fee is **10% of capital cost OR 10% of monthly emoluments**, whichever is less (monthly = annual ÷ 12).

FR 45-C. Emoluments for FR 45-A & FR 45-B

- (a) basic pay, fee, allowances and compensatory allowances (other than CEA, TA and Dress Allowance);
- (b) for a Government servant under suspension drawing a subsistence grant — the amount of the subsistence grant;
- (c) the amount of original pension before commutation; and
- (d) family pension does NOT fall within the purview of emoluments under the CCS (Pension) Rules.

FR 46. Fees and Honoraria

- **(a) Fee** — a recurring or non-recurring payment from a source other than the Consolidated Fund of India.
- **(b) Honorarium** — a recurring or non-recurring payment from the Consolidated Fund of India.

Government Decisions under FR 46

(1) Honorarium for a Master Trainer (rates from 2012):

Duration of course	Revised payment
Up to 1 week	Rs. 5,000
Up to 2 weeks	Rs. 7,500
Up to 3 weeks	Rs. 10,000
Up to 4 weeks	Rs. 12,500

(2) Honorarium in departmental proceedings — for serving officers:

Role (serving, part-time)	Rate per case
Inquiry Officer	15% of basic pay drawn
Presenting Officer	10% of basic pay drawn

Honorarium for a Retired Inquiry Officer:

Category	No. of witnesses in charge-sheet	Rate per case
I	More than 10	90% of monthly basic pension
II	Between 6 and 10	70% of monthly basic pension
III	Fewer than 6	60% of monthly basic pension

Allied charges in departmental proceedings:

Item	Condition	Rate
Transport allowance	—	Rs. 40,000 per case
Secretarial assistance	More than 10 witnesses	Rs. 40,000
Secretarial assistance	Between 6 and 10 witnesses	Rs. 30,000
Secretarial assistance	Fewer than 6 witnesses	Rs. 20,000

Note

In the case of common proceedings, an additional Rs. 5,000 is payable to the Inquiry Officer (both retired and serving).

Chapter VI — Combination of Appointments

FR 49. Holding Additional / Dual Charge

The Central Government may appoint a Government servant already holding a post to officiate, as a temporary measure, in one or more other independent posts. His pay is then regulated as follows:

- **(i) Full charge, same office & cadre / line of promotion:** he is allowed the pay admissible for the higher post. (e.g. a DPS appointed to hold full charge of the duties of the PMG.)
- **(ii) Dual charge of two posts in the same cadre & office on identical scales:** no additional pay, irrespective of the period — but if the additional post carries a special pay, that special pay is allowed. (e.g. a Division Head holding additional charge of another Division.)
- **(iii) Charge of a post not in the same office (or in the same office but not in the same cadre / line of promotion):** he is allowed the pay of the higher / highest post PLUS 10% of the presumptive pay of the additional post(s), if the additional charge is held for a period exceeding 45 days but not exceeding 3 months. (e.g. a PMG holding charge of a higher post as CPMG and as Member of the Board.) Beyond 3 months, the concurrence of the DoPT is required for payment of the additional pay.
- **(iv) Ceiling:** the aggregate of pay and additional pay must in no case exceed Rs. 2,37,500.
- **(v) Current charge of routine duties:** NO additional pay, irrespective of the duration of the additional charge.

Chapter VII — Deputation Out of India

FR 50. Sanction for Deputation

No deputation of a Government servant out of India may be sanctioned without the previous approval of the Central Government.

FR 51. Pay During Deputation

When deputed for duty out of India (or on special duty in India) with proper sanction, the President may allow the Government servant to draw, during the deputation, the same pay he would have drawn had he remained on duty in India.

Foreign-service eligibility & limits (DoPT Consolidated Guidelines, OM dated 28.03.2024)

A Central Government officer is eligible for deputation / foreign service only after completing 9 years of service and being clear from the vigilance angle.

The officer should not have dealt with the borrowing organisation in the last 5 years, and no blood relation of his should be connected with that organisation.

Maximum deputation / foreign service in one stretch — 5 years (extendable up to 7 years in public interest, with prescribed approvals).

Cooling-off period: Joint Secretary level and below — 3 years; Additional Secretary level — 1 year; Secretary level — Nil.

Chapter VIII — Dismissal, Removal and Suspension**FR 52. Cessation of Pay and Allowances**

The pay and allowances of a Government servant who is dismissed or removed cease from the date of such dismissal or removal.

FR 53. Subsistence Allowance During Suspension

A Government servant under suspension (or deemed to be under suspension) is entitled to:

- **(i) Subsistence allowance** — 50% of the leave salary the servant would have drawn on half-pay leave, plus dearness allowance thereon.
- **(ii) Increase:** subsistence allowance may be increased by up to 50% of the first-three-months rate where suspension is prolonged after review for reasons NOT directly attributable to the Government servant.
- **(iii) Decrease:** subsistence allowance may be reduced by up to 50% of the first-three-months rate where the prolongation, after review, is found directly attributable to the Government servant.

No subsistence allowance is paid unless the Government servant furnishes a certificate that he is not engaged in any other employment, business, profession or vocation.

Government Decisions under FR 53

- (a) If the revised pay scale takes effect from a date before suspension, the benefit of the increase flows to the subsistence allowance too.
- (b) Suspension must be reviewed within **3 months** from the date of suspension.

- (c) Interim relief drawn before suspension continues at the same percentage.

(d) Recoveries from subsistence allowance:

- **Compulsory deductions:** income tax; house rent and allied charges (electricity, water, furniture, etc.); repayment of loans and advances; CGHS contribution; CGEGIS (1980) contribution.
 - **Optional deductions (with written consent):** PLI premium; amounts due to co-operative societies; refund of advances taken from GPF.
 - **Not to be recovered:** GPF subscription; amounts due on court attachment; recovery of loss to Government for which the servant is responsible.
- (e) The licence-fee-free concession ceases from the date of suspension; licence fee is recovered thereafter.

FR 54. Reinstatement and Regularisation of Pay

1. When a Government servant who was dismissed, removed or compulsorily retired is reinstated on appeal / review (or would have been but for superannuation), the competent authority must make a specific order on (a) the pay and allowances for the period of absence (including suspension preceding the dismissal etc.), and (b) whether that period is treated as duty.
2. If the authority is of opinion that he has been fully exonerated, he is paid full pay and allowances, and the period of absence (including the preceding suspension) is treated as duty for all purposes.

FR 54-A. Reinstatement by a Court of Law

1. Where dismissal / removal / compulsory retirement is set aside by a court and the official is reinstated, the period is regularised and pay & allowances are decided in accordance with the court's judgment.
2. If the order is set aside on the MERITS, the intervening period (including the preceding suspension) is treated as duty for all purposes and full pay & allowances are paid.

FR 54-B. Death or Conversion of Suspension into Leave

- (2) If the official dies under suspension before completion of proceedings, the period from suspension to death is treated as duty and full pay & allowances are paid to the family (after adjusting subsistence allowance already paid).

- (7) If the Government servant so desires, the competent authority may convert the period of suspension (or absence) preceding dismissal etc. into leave of any kind due and admissible, within the limits below:
 - EOL up to **3 months** in the case of a temporary Government servant.
 - Leave of any kind up to **5 years** in the case of a permanent / quasi-permanent Government servant.

Note

A higher authority may sanction conversion of the suspension period into leave without any limit.

Government Decisions under FR 54-B

- (a) The period of suspension is treated as duty if only a minor penalty is finally imposed.
- (b) Where the competent authority concludes that erroneous detention / detention without basis in police custody made the suspension wholly unjustified, full pay & allowances may be allowed.

FR 55. Leave Under Suspension

Leave may NOT be granted to a Government servant under suspension.

Chapter IX — Retirement**FR 56(a). Age of Superannuation**

Every Government servant retires on the afternoon of the **last day of the month** in which he attains the age of **60 years**. A Government servant whose date of birth is the first of a month retires on the afternoon of the last day of the preceding month on attaining 60 years.

- **FR 56(bb):** the age of superannuation for specialists in the Teaching, Non-Teaching and Public Health sub-cadres of the Central Health Service (CHS) is **62 years**. *First proviso:* specialists of the Teaching sub-cadre engaged **only in teaching** (and not occupying administrative positions) superannuate at **65 years**; *second proviso:* those in administrative positions may opt for teaching positions to continue up to 65 years.

- **FR 56(bbb):** the age of superannuation for nursing teaching faculty with an M.Sc. (Nursing) in Central Government Nursing Institutions is **65 years**, subject to their continuing to function as faculty members after the age of 60.

Government Decisions on Extension of Service

1. Extension up to 3 months may be granted to a Government servant engaged in budget work.
2. A specialist in a medical or scientific field may be granted extension up to age 62 years.
3. An eminent scientist of international stature may be granted extension up to age 64 years.
4. The Cabinet Secretary's service may be extended for such period(s) as do not exceed 4 years in aggregate.
5. Extension of 2 years may be granted to the Home Secretary and the Defence Secretary.

FR 56(i). Military Officers in Civil Departments

A military officer in a civil department ceases to be in civil employment on the date he attains the age of 60 years.

FR 56(j). Premature Retirement in Public Interest

The Appropriate Authority has the absolute right, in the public interest, to retire any Government servant by giving **3 months' notice in writing (or 3 months' pay and allowances in lieu)**:

- (i) for Group A & B servants who entered service before the age of 35 years — after attaining the age of 50 years; and
- (ii) in other cases — after attaining the age of 55 years.

FR 56(k). Voluntary Retirement

A Government servant may, by giving 3 months' notice in writing, retire after attaining the age of 50 years (Group A / B, if entered service before age 35) or, in other cases, after attaining the age of 55 years. The appropriate authority may withhold permission where:

- the Government servant is under suspension;
- a charge-sheet has been issued and disciplinary proceedings are pending; or
- judicial proceedings on charges amounting to grave misconduct are pending.

FR 56(l) & (m). Premature / Voluntary Retirement of Group 'C'

- **FR 56(l):** the Appropriate Authority has the absolute right, in the public interest, to retire a Group 'C' Government servant not governed by any pension rules after he has completed **30 years' service**, on 3 months' notice (or pay in lieu).
- **FR 56(m):** such a Group 'C' Government servant may himself retire, on 3 months' notice, after completing **30 years' service** (subject to the same withholding conditions as FR 56(k)).

Government Decisions on Retirement & Periodic Review

- **(i)** A request for change of date of birth may be entertained only within **5 years** of entry into Government service.
- **(ii)** Strengthening of administration — periodic review under FR 56(j) / FR 56(l) / Rule 42 of the CCS (Pension) Rules 2021. The review is made about **six months** before the Government servant attains the age of 50 / 55 years, or completes 30 years' service / 30 years' qualifying service, as the case may be, in the schedule below:

Quarter in which review is made	For employees attaining 50/55 yrs or completing 30 yrs in the quarter
January to March	July to September of the same year
April to June	October to December of the same year
July to September	January to March of the next year
October to December	April to June of the next year

Authority

FR 56(j)/(l) read with Rule 42, CCS (Pension) Rules 2021 (which replaced Rule 48 of the CCS (Pension) Rules 1972); DoPT consolidated guidelines OM dated 28.08.2020.

Chapter XI — Joining Time**FR 108. Consequences of Overstaying Joining Time**

A Government servant who does not join his post within his joining time is entitled to no pay or leave salary after the end of the joining time. Wilful absence after expiry of joining time may be treated as misbehaviour for the purpose of FR 15.

Chapter XII — Foreign Service

FR 110. Transfer to Foreign Service

- (a) No Government servant may be transferred to foreign service against his will.
- (b) Transfer to foreign service in or outside India may be sanctioned by the Central Government, subject to restrictions it may impose.

Government Decisions

- (a) A temporary Government servant is eligible for foreign service.
- (b) For the purpose of the foreign-service rules, Nepal is treated as outside India.

FR 112. Transfer on Foreign Service During Leave

If a Government servant is transferred to foreign service while on leave, he ceases — from the date of transfer — to be on leave and to draw leave salary.

FR 113. Cadre During Foreign Service

There is no change in cadre during foreign service.

FR 114. Pay from Foreign Employer

- (a) A Government servant in foreign service draws pay from the foreign employer from the date he relinquishes charge of his post in Government service.
- (b) The amount of pay, the joining time admissible and the pay during such joining time are fixed by the sanctioning authority in consultation with the foreign employer (subject to any restrictions imposed by the President).

FR 115. Pension & Leave-Salary Contributions During Foreign Service

1. Contribution towards pension is paid by the Government servant himself, whether the foreign service is in or out of India.
2. Contribution towards leave salary, when on deputation in India, is paid by the Government servant himself.
3. By special arrangement, the contribution towards leave salary is paid by the foreign employer when the deputation is out of India.

FR 116. Rates of Contribution

Rates of contribution (w.e.f. 1st April 2019):

- **NPS employee** — 28% of (basic pay + DA): employer's contribution @ 14% + employee's contribution @ 10% + 4% towards gratuity.

- **OPS employee** — 18% of (basic pay + DA): monthly contribution by the employee @ 14% + 4% towards gratuity.
- **Leave-salary contribution** — 11% of (basic pay + DA) for all Government servants in foreign service.

FR 120. Counting of Foreign Service as Duty

- If the monthly pension contribution is paid on his behalf and maintains his claim to pension, the foreign service is treated as duty for pension.
- Neither the Government servant nor the foreign employer has any right of property in the contribution paid; no claim for refund is entertained.

FR 121. Restriction on Foreign Pension

A Government servant transferred to foreign service may NOT, without the sanction of the Central Government, accept a pension or gratuity from his foreign employer in respect of such service.

FR 125 & FR 126. Reversion from Foreign Service

- **FR 125:** a Government servant reverts from foreign service on the date he takes charge of his post in Government service.
- **FR 126:** on reversion, pay from the foreign employer ceases and the contributions are discontinued, with effect from the date of reversion.

PART B — SUPPLEMENTARY RULES (GENERAL)

The Supplementary Rules (SR) supplement the Fundamental Rules. This Part covers the general / procedural Supplementary Rules — medical fitness on first entry, acceptance of fees, foreign-service contributions, deputation allowance, and the maintenance of the service book. The travelling-allowance Supplementary Rules are dealt with separately in Part C.

Medical Certificate of Fitness

SR 4. Authority to Sign the Fitness Certificate

- (a) For a gazetted Government servant — the certificate is signed by a Medical Board.
- (b) For a non-gazetted Government servant — by a Civil Surgeon, District Medical Officer, or a Medical Officer of equivalent status.

SR 4(a). Exemption from Producing the Certificate at Joining

1. A Government servant recruited through a competitive examination who already underwent medical examination as per the prescribed regulations.
2. A qualified student of Thomason College, Roorkee, permanently appointed to the Public Works Department within 18 months from the date of the health certificate granted on completing the college course.
3. A Government servant appointed in a temporary vacancy for a period not exceeding 3 months.
4. A temporary Government servant already medically examined in one office, on transfer to another office without a break in service.
5. A retired Government servant re-employed immediately after retirement.

Government Decisions

- (a) A right of appeal lies against an adverse finding, with a re-examination fee of Rs. 100 for a gazetted post and Rs. 25 for a non-gazetted post.
- (b) Re-employment of non-gazetted staff is allowed without fresh medical examination where the break in service does not exceed one year.

Fees**SR 11. Acceptance of Fees**

No Government servant may undertake work for another Government / a private or public body / a private person, or accept a fee for it, without the sanction of the Competent Authority. Unless the Government servant is on leave, the authority must certify that the work can be undertaken without detriment to his official duties and responsibilities.

SR 12. Crediting Fees to Government

Unless the President otherwise directs, **one-third (1/3) of any fees in excess of Rs. 5,000** paid to a Government servant in a financial year is credited to the Consolidated Fund of India.

Worked example

If a Government servant earns a fee of Rs. 9,500 in a financial year, the amount to be credited to the Consolidated Fund of India is:

$$(\text{Fee} - 5,000) \div 3 = (9,500 - 5,000) \div 3 = \text{Rs. } 1,500.$$

Record of Service

SR 196 & SR 197. Who Keeps the Record

- **SR 196** — the record of service of a gazetted Government servant is kept by the Audit Officer.
- **SR 197** — non-gazetted Government servants are governed by the service-book system.

SR 198. Maintenance of the Service Book

A service book is maintained for a Government servant from the date of his first appointment. It is kept in the custody of the Head of Office where he serves and is transferred with him from office to office.

Government Decisions under SR 198

- (i) The service book is maintained in duplicate.
- (ii) The first copy is retained by the Head of Office.
- (iii) The second copy is given to the Government servant.
- (iv) For existing employees — within **6 months** of these rules becoming effective; for new appointees — within **1 month** of appointment.
- (v) In January each year, the Government servant hands over his copy to the office for updating.
- (vi) The office updates and returns it within **30 days** of receipt.
- (vii) If the Government servant's copy is lost by him, it is replaced on payment of **Rs. 500**.
- (viii) On technical resignation, the service book is transferred from the parent department to the present department.

SR 199. Attestation of Entries

Every step of an official's official life must be recorded in the service book, and each entry must be attested by the Head of Office (or, if he is himself the Head of Office, by his immediate superior). The descriptive particulars are re-attested every **5 years**.

SR 200. Recording Suspensions & Interruptions

Every period of suspension and every other interruption of service must be recorded, with full details of its duration, in an entry made across the page of the service book, and must be attested by the Attesting Officer.

SR 202. Annual Inspection of the Service Book

Every Head of Office must show the service books to the Government servants under his control every year and obtain their signatures in token of inspection. A certificate to this effect, for the preceding financial year, must be submitted to his next superior officer by the end of **September** each year.

SR 203. Transfer to Foreign Service

On transfer to foreign service, the Head of Office / Department must send the service book to the Audit Officer.

- (1) No entry relating to time spent in foreign service may be attested by any authority other than the Audit Officer (annual verification of the service book is done by the Head of Office).
- (2) Verification and communication of qualifying service is done after **18 years** of service or **5 years** before retirement.

Foreign Service — Contributions & Allowances

SR 307. Interest on Overdue Contributions

- Contributions for leave salary or pension in respect of a Government servant on foreign service may be paid annually within **15 days** from the end of each financial year (or at the end of the foreign service, if it expires earlier).
- If payment is not made within that period, interest is payable to Government on the unpaid contribution at the rate of **2 paise per day per Rs. 100**.

SR 307-A. Travelling Allowance for Foreign Service

The travelling allowance for both the journey on transfer to foreign service and the journey on reversion is borne by the foreign employer.

Rate of Deputation (Duty) Allowance

- (i) 5% of basic pay, subject to a maximum of **Rs. 5,625 per month**, where the deputation is at the same station.
- (ii) 10% of basic pay, subject to a maximum of **Rs. 11,250 per month**, where the deputation involves a change of station.

Updated rates — verified

The base ceilings of Rs. 4,500 / Rs. 9,000 (DoPT OM No. 2/11/2017-Estt.(Pay-II) dated 24.11.2017) rise by 25% each time DA crosses a 50% multiple. As DA crossed 50% w.e.f. 01.01.2024, the current ceilings are Rs. 5,625 and Rs. 11,250 respectively.

Basic pay + Deputation (Duty) Allowance must not exceed the apex-level pay (Rs. 2,25,000); where NPA is drawn, basic + NPA + the allowance must not exceed Rs. 2,37,500.

Exam pointers — SR General

SR 12: only 1/3 of fees ABOVE Rs. 5,000 in a financial year is credited to the Consolidated Fund — the first Rs. 5,000 is fully retained.

Service book is in duplicate; lost servant's copy replaced for Rs. 500; descriptive particulars re-attested every 5 years.

Deputation (Duty) Allowance: 5%/10%, ceilings now Rs. 5,625 / Rs. 11,250 after the 25% DA-linked enhancement.

CCS (JOINING TIME) RULES, 1979

These rules govern the joining time admissible to a Government servant on transfer. They came into force on **19th May 1979**. Joining time is granted on transfer in the public interest to enable the Government servant to join the new post, whether at the same or a new station.

Rule 4. Temporary Transfer

No joining time is admissible on temporary transfer for a period not exceeding **180 days**; only the actual transit time (as on tour) is allowed.

Rule 5 & 6. Surplus Staff and Conversion of Break

- Rule 5 — surplus staff transferred from one post to another are eligible for joining time.
- Rule 6 — a break may be converted into joining time without pay by the Head of Department, provided the break does not exceed **30 days** and the Government servant has rendered not less than **3 years** of continuous service on the date of his discharge.

Rule 7. Commencement of Joining Time

Joining time commences from the date of relinquishment of charge of the old post if charge is made over in the forenoon, or from the following day if charge is made over in the afternoon.

Rule 8. Transfer Within the Same Station

Only **one day** joining time is allowed for a new post in the same station where it does not involve a change of residence. "Same station" means within the area of the same municipality.

Rule 9. Joining Time on Change of Station

Where the transfer involves a change of station, joining time is admissible by distance as below:

Distance between old & new station	Joining time	If road journey > 200 km
1,000 km or less	10 days	12 days
More than 1,000 km and up to 2,000 km	12 days	15 days
More than 2,000 km	15 days (by air: 12 days)	15 days

Note

When holiday(s) follow joining time, the joining time is deemed extended to cover such holiday(s).

For transfer to the N-E Region, Sikkim, A&N Islands, Lakshadweep and Ladakh, two additional days are allowed.

Rule 10. Extension of Joining Time

Joining time may be extended by a maximum of **30 days** by the Head of Department, and beyond 30 days by the Department of the Government of India.

Rule 11. Unutilised Joining Time

Where a Government servant joins the new post without availing of full joining time (or is ordered to join without availing it, or proceeds alone and joins without availing it), the unutilised joining time is credited to his earned-leave account, subject to a maximum accumulation of **300 days**.

Rule 12 & 13. Combination and Pay

- Rule 12 — joining time may be combined with vacation and/or regular leave of any kind or duration, except casual leave.
- Rule 13 — a Government servant on joining time is treated as on duty and is paid joining-time pay equal to the pay drawn before relinquishment of charge of the old post.

Rule 14. On Technical Resignation

A permanent / provisionally-permanent State or Central Government employee appointed under the Central Government is entitled to joining time. A temporary Government servant with less than **3 years** of regular service is NOT entitled to travelling allowance, as he is not entitled to joining-time pay under these rules.

Rule 15 & 16. Own-Request Transfer and Cancellation

- Rule 15 — on own-request transfer: (a) regular leave may be granted to cover the transit period; (b) leave is not required to avail intervening holiday(s).
- Rule 16 — where a transfer order is cancelled after handing over the old post but before taking over the new post, the intervening period is treated as joining time.

PART C — TRAVELLING ALLOWANCE (TA) RULES

The Travelling Allowance Rules form **Part II of the FR & SR**. They prescribe the entitlements for journeys on tour, transfer, training and retirement, and the daily allowance, mileage allowance and reimbursement of expenses. The entitlements are now based on the **Pay Level in the Pay Matrix** under the CCS (Revised Pay) Rules, 2016, with effect from 01.07.2017. Several monetary ceilings rose by **25%** when DA crossed 50% (w.e.f. 01.01.2024); those enhanced figures are used throughout this Part.

SR 1 & SR 2 — Short Title and Definitions

These rules are called the Supplementary Rules. The key definitions are:

(1) Actual travelling expenses — the actual cost of transporting a Government servant with his servants and personal luggage, including charges for ferry and other tolls, and for carriage of camp equipment if necessary.

(2) **Apprentice** — a person deputed for training in a trade or business with a view to employment in Government service, who draws pay at monthly rates during training but is not employed against a substantive vacancy.

(3) **Day** — a calendar day, beginning and ending at midnight.

(4) **Family** — a Government servant's wife or husband residing with him/her, and legitimate children and step-children residing with and wholly dependent upon him/her.

Government Decisions on “Family” (for TA)

(a) Not more than one wife is included in the term “family”.

(b) Restricted to two children with effect from 01.01.1999 for TA on transfer.

(c) An adopted child is treated as a legitimate child if the adoption is legally recognised as conferring the status of a natural child.

(d) Children include major sons, and married daughters (separated / who have abandoned their husbands) including widowed daughters, so long as they reside with and are wholly dependent upon the parent.

(e) Parents, widowed sisters, minor brothers and step-mother are included if wholly dependent upon the Government servant.

(f) Step-father is NOT included for TA on transfer, but IS included as a family member for LTC.

(5) **Hill Station** — any place declared to be a hill station by a Competent Authority.

(6) **Probationer** — a Government servant employed on probation against a substantive vacancy in the cadre of a department.

(7) **Public conveyance** — a train, steamer or other conveyance which plies regularly for the conveyance of passengers.

(8) **Transfer** — the movement of a Government servant from one headquarters station to another, either (a) to take up the duties of a new post, or (b) in consequence of a change of his headquarters.

Chapter I — Grades (Levels) of Government Servants

With effect from 01.07.2017, entitlements are determined by the Pay Level in the Pay Matrix. The grouping is: (i) **Level 14 and above**; (ii) **Levels 12 & 13**; (iii) **Levels 9 to 11**; (iv) **Levels 6 to 8**; (v) **Level 5 and below**.

Note

The term “pay in the level” for TA purposes does NOT include NPA.

SR 19. Transit Between Posts

A Government servant in transit from one post to another ranks in the grade to which the lower of the two posts would entitle him.

Chapter II – Different Kinds of Travelling Allowance**Rule 21. Kinds of Travelling Allowance**

- (a) Permanent travelling allowance;
- (b) Conveyance or horse allowance;
- (c) Mileage allowance;
- (d) Daily allowance; and
- (e) the actual cost of travelling.

1. Permanent Travelling Allowance (Rules 22–23)

A permanent monthly travelling allowance may be granted to a Government servant whose duties require extensive travel. It is granted in lieu of all other forms of TA for journeys within his sphere of duty and is drawn all year round, whether or not he is absent from headquarters.

- It is NOT drawn during leave, temporary transfer or joining time, or during any period for which another kind of TA is drawn.
- Calculation on absence: **1/30 of the PTA** is deducted for each day of absence.

2. Conveyance Allowance / Horse Allowance (Rules 25–27)

A competent authority may grant a monthly conveyance or horse allowance to a Government servant required to travel extensively at or near his headquarters under conditions that do not make him eligible for daily allowance.

Conditions for grant of conveyance allowance:

- (1) Not admissible unless the average monthly running on duty exceeds **200 km**.
- (2) The distance from residence to office and back is not reckoned for this purpose.
- (3) Journeys performed by bicycle do not qualify for conveyance allowance.
- (4) It is paid only if the Government servant uses a motorcycle or car.

- (5) Not admissible when absence from headquarters exceeds **15 days** in a calendar month.
- (6) Not admissible during joining time, leave, or any period of temporary transfer (including holidays prefixed/suffixed to leave).
- (7) An officer granted conveyance allowance gets no other TA (daily or mileage) for journeys up to **16 km** from the usual place of work at HQ; beyond 16 km, admissible TA / mileage / full DA may be drawn.
- (8) Granted for a period not exceeding **two years** at a time.

(9) Rate of conveyance allowance on official duty:

Average monthly travel	Own motor car	Other modes of conveyance
201 – 300 km	Rs. 2,100	Rs. 695
301 – 450 km	Rs. 3,150	Rs. 900
451 – 600 km	Rs. 3,881	Rs. 1,200
601 – 800 km	Rs. 4,558	Rs. 1,374
More than 800 km	Rs. 5,625	Rs. 1,595

Updated rates

The conveyance-allowance rates above reflect the 25% increase effective 01.01.2024, consequent to DA reaching 50%. Pre-2024 rates have been superseded.

- (10) Cycle allowance is sanctioned by Divisional Heads at **Rs. 180 per month**, with a minimum daily distance of 16 km.
- (11) Cycle allowance is not admissible for a calendar month wholly covered by leave, training or temporary transfer.
- (12) Cycle allowance is granted for not more than **two years** at a time, and is reviewed after two years.
- (13) A substitute in a leave vacancy is eligible for cycle allowance.
- (14) Cycle allowance of Rs. 180 per month applies to ABPM / BPM / DS, with a minimum daily distance of **10 km**.

Transport Allowance (TPA)

Rates of Transport Allowance per month:

Pay Level	Posted in listed cities	Posted in other places
9 and above	Rs. 7,200 + DA	Rs. 3,600 + DA

Pay Level	Posted in listed cities	Posted in other places
3 to 8	Rs. 3,600 + DA	Rs. 1,800 + DA
1 and 2	Rs. 1,350 + DA	Rs. 900 + DA

- Employees drawing pay of **Rs. 24,200 and above** in Levels 1 and 2 are entitled to TPA of Rs. 3,600 + DA (listed cities) and Rs. 1,800 + DA (other places).

Conditions for grant of Transport Allowance:

- (a) Not admissible to employees provided with a Government vehicle.
- (b) Physically disabled employees (visually impaired, orthopaedically handicapped, deaf and dumb / hearing-impaired, spinal deformity) are paid TPA at **double the normal rate**, subject to a minimum of Rs. 2,250 + DA.
- (c) A person with one eye / one hand is not equated with an orthopaedically-handicapped person having a deformity in one limb, and is not entitled to the double rate.
- (d) Not admissible to officers in Level 14 and above who are entitled to the use of an official car.

Admissibility in special circumstances:

- During leave: not admissible if the completed calendar month is covered by leave.
- During deputation abroad: not admissible.
- During tour: not admissible if the official is on tour for a completed calendar month.
- During training treated as duty: granted if no transport facility / TA / DA is provided for attending the training institute.
- During suspension: not admissible where suspension covers a full calendar month; where suspension covers a month partially, TPA is reduced proportionately.

3. Mileage Allowance (Rules 29–46)

Rule 29–31. Basis and Route

Mileage allowance is the form of TA calculated on the distance travelled, to meet the cost of a particular journey.

- A journey between two places is held to have been performed by the shortest of two or more practicable routes (the route by which the traveller can most speedily reach his destination by ordinary modes).

- If a Government servant travels by a route that is not the shortest but is cheaper, mileage is calculated on the route actually used.
- A competent authority may, for recorded special reasons, permit mileage on a route other than the shortest / cheapest, provided the journey is actually performed by that route.

Rule 32. Where a Journey Begins / Ends

A journey on transfer begins or ends at the actual residence of the Government servant. Any other journey begins or ends at the duty point in the station (the headquarters / office place of the Government servant).

Rule 35. Class of Railway Accommodation

Travel entitlements within the country (on tour or training):

Pay Level	Rail travel entitlement
14 and above	AC First Class (all premium / Tatkal / Suvidha / Shatabdi / Rajdhani / Tejas trains)
12 to 13	Executive / AC First Class (premium / Suvidha / Shatabdi / Rajdhani / Tejas / Vande Bharat trains)
6 to 11	AC Second Class / Chair Car (Shatabdi / Tejas / Vande Bharat trains)
5 and below	First Class / AC Third Class / AC Chair Car

- Officials may travel by premium / premium-Tatkal / Suvidha trains, with reimbursement of premium-Tatkal charges and of dynamic / flexi fare in Shatabdi / Rajdhani / Durgam / Tejas trains on official tour / training.

Subject to the following:

- (a) For places not connected by rail — AC bus for those entitled to AC II Tier and above by train, and Deluxe / ordinary bus for others.
- (b) For road travel between rail-connected places — any means of public transport, provided the total fare does not exceed the entitled-class train fare.
- (c) On non-availability of seats in the entitled class — travel in the class below the entitled class.

Fare for children:

Age	Fare	Remarks
Under 5 years	Nil	Without berth, reserved or non-reserved

Age	Fare	Remarks
5 and under 12 years	Half adult fare	If a separate berth/seat is not sought (un-reserved)
5 and under 12 years	Full adult fare	If a separate berth/seat is sought

Journeys by Sea / River Steamer (Rule 35 contd.)

(i) For places other than the A&N and Lakshadweep groups of islands:

Pay Level	Travel entitlement
9 and above	Highest class
6 to 8	Lower class, if there are only two classes on the steamer
4 to 5	If two classes: lower class; if three classes: middle/second; if four classes: third class
3 and below	Lowest class

(ii) Between the mainland and the A&N / Lakshadweep islands by SCI ships:

Pay Level	Travel entitlement
6 and above	Deluxe class
5 and below	Second / 'B' Cabin class

Rule 46. Mileage Allowance for Journeys by Road

(i) At places where specific rates have been prescribed:

Pay Level	Entitlement
14 and above	Actual fare by any type of public bus (incl. AC bus) / AC taxi / autorickshaw / own car / scooter / motorcycle
6 to 13	As above, except AC taxi
5 and below	Actual fare by ordinary (non-AC) public bus / autorickshaw / own car / scooter / motorcycle

(ii) At places where no specific rates have been prescribed:

Journey performed by	Rate
Own car / taxi	Rs. 30 per km
Autorickshaw / own scooter etc.	Rs. 15 per km

Journey performed by	Rate
Updated rates Road-mileage rates reflect the 25% enhancement effective 01.01.2024 (DA at 50%). The earlier rates of Rs. 24 and Rs. 12 per km have been superseded by Rs. 30 and Rs. 15 respectively.	

4. Air Travel on Tour / Training within the Country (w.e.f. 01.07.2017)

Pay Level	Travel entitlement
14 and above	Business / Club Class by air
12 to 13	Economy class by air
6 to 11	Economy class by air

5. International Travel Entitlement (w.e.f. 01.07.2017)

Pay Level	Travel entitlement
17 and above	First class
14 to 16	Business / Club Class by air
13 and below	Economy class by air

Rule 51 – Daily Allowance (DA on Tour)

(i) Daily allowance as per entitlement:

Pay Level	Food (Rs.)	Hotel (Rs.)	Taxi charges
14 and above	1,500	9,375	AC taxi within the city
12 and 13	1,250	5,625	AC taxi up to 50 km within the city
9 to 11	1,125	2,812.50	Non-AC taxi: Rs. 422.50/day
6 to 8	1,000	937.50	Non-AC taxi: Rs. 281.25/day
5 and below	625	562.50	Non-AC taxi: Rs. 141.25/day

Updated rates

Hotel, food and taxi ceilings reflect the 25% increase effective 01.01.2024 (DA at 50%). All limits up to 31.12.2023 have been superseded.

- **(ii) Reimbursement of hotel charges:** for Levels 8 and below, the claim (up to the ceiling) may be paid on a self-certified claim without vouchers; in X-class cities, hotel charges exceeding Rs. 1,250 require vouchers. GST / taxes are calculated on the actual charge and reimbursed over and above the prescribed entitlement.

- **(iii) Reimbursement of travelling charges:** up to Level 11 and below, the claim (up to the ceiling) may be paid on a self-certified claim without vouchers. For journeys on foot, an allowance of **Rs. 15 per km** is payable additionally.
- **(iv) Reimbursement of food charges:** there is no separate reimbursement of food bills; instead a lump-sum amount is paid depending on the length of absence from headquarters, with no vouchers required:

Absence from headquarters	DA admissible
More than 12 hours	100%
6 hours and up to 12 hours	70%
Less than 6 hours	30%

Government Decisions on Daily Allowance

- (a) DA for an enforced halt at the tour station / en route (due to curfew, bandh, blockage of roads, rain, snowfall, landslide, etc.): special (casual) leave may be granted, and the official is entitled to daily allowance.
- (b) DA to an official on tour returning to headquarters daily (except Sunday and holidays) is admissible as per TA rules for the actual stay on tour / temporary transfer.
- (c) DA on continuous halt / temporary transfer: first **180 days** — full rate; beyond 180 days — Nil.

(d) TA entitlement for deputation to undergo training in India:

- (1) Where boarding & lodging are NOT provided: first **180 days** — full DA; beyond 180 days — Nil.
- (2) Where boarding & lodging facilities exist: first **30 days** — full DA; next **150 days** — half DA.

Rule 53-A. Actual Expenses (Toll Tax)

Toll tax charged at a station by a municipality / corporation, limited to the amount actually paid, may be allowed to a Government servant proceeding on tour, in addition to the TA otherwise admissible.

Chapter III — TA for Different Classes of Journeys

Rule 71. Minimum Distance for Daily Allowance

Daily allowance may not be drawn for any day on which a Government servant does not reach a point **outside a radius of 8 km** from the duty point at his headquarters (or return to it from such a point).

Government Decisions on Local Journeys

- (1) Where an official rail journey is cancelled in the public interest, cancellation and reservation charges are reimbursed under the head "Travel expenses" in the TA bill.
- (2) A local journey is one within the municipal limits / city of the duty point, including journeys within suburban or other municipalities and within the urban agglomeration of the headquarters.
- (3) Regulation of TA for local journeys: TA is admissible if the temporary place is beyond **8 km** from the normal place of duty (whether the journey is from residence or from the normal duty place). DA is admissible at **50%** of the normal entitlement:

Absence from headquarters	DA admissible (local journey)
More than 12 hours	50%
6 hours and up to 12 hours	35%
Less than 6 hours	15%

Rule 90. Tolls and Fares Within 8 km

A Government servant travelling on duty within 8 km of his headquarters may recover the actual amounts spent on ferry / other tolls and fares for journeys by railway or other public conveyance, and the actual expenses of maintaining camp equipage during a halt at headquarters.

1. Journey to First Appointment

Rule 105. TA for the First Journey

Except as otherwise provided, TA is not admissible for the journey to join one's first post in Government service. However, TA limited to ordinary bus fare / second-class rail fare is admissible for the Government servant and his family for the total distance (e.g. on first appointment to a post in the N-E Region / A&N Islands / Lakshadweep).

Rule 107 & 108. Re-appointment and Sea Passage

- Rule 107 — applies when a pensioner, or a Government servant thrown out of employment by a reduction of establishment or abolition of his post, is re-appointed to Government service.
- Rule 108 — when a person is appointed to a post which he cannot join except by sea, a competent authority may grant a free sea passage from one part of India to another.

2. Journey on Transfer

Rule 114. TA on Transfer

TA on transfer is admissible only where the transfer is for the public convenience and the Government servant is entitled to pay during the journey period. A transfer on his own request is not treated as for the public convenience unless the sanctioning authority, for recorded special reasons, directs otherwise.

Four Components of TA on Transfer

1. **Travelling allowance for self and family** — as per TA rules, for the Government servant and his entitled family.
2. **Composite Transfer Grant and Packing Grant (CTG)** — see below.
3. **Reimbursement of charges for transportation of personal effects** — see table below.
4. **Reimbursement of charges for transportation of conveyance** — see table below.

Composite Transfer Grant (CTG)

- (i) CTG is **80% of the last basic pay** for a transfer involving a change of station at a distance of 20 km or more. For the A&N Islands and Lakshadweep, CTG is **100% of the last basic pay**. NPA and MSP are NOT included in computing CTG.
- (ii) For transfers to stations less than 20 km away, and transfers within the same city, **one-third of the CTG** is admissible, provided a change of residence is actually involved.
- (iii) Where the transfer of husband and wife takes place within 6 months but after 60 days of the spouse's transfer, **50% of the CTG** is allowed to the spouse transferred later. If both transfers are ordered within 60 days, no CTG is admissible

to the spouse transferred later. The normal provisions apply if the transfers are 6 months or more apart.

Note

CTG and TA on a transfer at one's own request, or otherwise than in the public interest, are NOT admissible.

(c) Transportation of Personal Effects

Pay Level	By train / steamer	Rate by road (w.e.f. 01.01.2024)
12 and above	6,000 kg by goods train / 4-wheeler wagon / 1 double container	Rs. 62.50 per km
6 to 11	6,000 kg by goods train / 4-wheeler wagon / single container	Rs. 62.50 per km
5	3,000 kg	Rs. 31.25 per km
4 and below	1,500 kg	Rs. 18.75 per km

Note

Reimbursement is subject to production of actual receipts / vouchers. Vouchers are mandatory for transfers to/from the N-E Region, A&N Islands and Lakshadweep.

The ceilings for transportation of personal effects rose by 25% from 01.01.2024 (DA at 50%).

(d) Transportation of Conveyance

Pay Level	Reimbursement
6 and above	One motor car etc., OR one motorcycle / scooter
5 and below	One motorcycle / scooter / moped / bicycle

Government Decisions on Transfer TA

1. TA is admissible to permanent / provisionally-permanent officials getting appointed under the Central Government through examination / interview.
2. Transfer TA on technical resignation is admissible to all permanent employees; a temporary Government servant requires 3 years' service for TA.
3. TA is admissible to officials appointed under a PSU under SR 114.
4. Officials transferred after completing full tenure are entitled to TA and transit even if posted to the place of their choice.

5. Entitlement of transfer TA is available in the case of children studying in educational institutions.

3. Journey to Attend an Examination

Rule 130–133. TA for Examinations

A Government servant is entitled to TA for the journey to and from the place where he appears for:

- (a) an obligatory examination (e.g. Postman / PA / SA / IP, PS Group B examinations); and
- (b) a language examination (e.g. Hindi examination).
- A Competent Authority may permit TA for the journey to and from any other examination (Rule 132).
- TA is calculated as for a journey on tour, but no allowance is drawn for halts (Rule 133).

Government Decisions

- (1) TA for candidates summoned by the UPSC for interview — second-class train fare.
- (2) TA for SC/ST candidates called for interview — second-class train or bus fare, where the distance is more than 30 km.

4. Journey on Recall to Duty

Rule 142. Recall from Leave

Where a Government servant is compulsorily recalled to duty before the expiry of his leave and the leave is thereby curtailed by **not less than one month**, he is entitled to mileage allowance for the journey from the place where the order of recall reaches him (or the port of landing, if by sea) to the station to which he is recalled. If the curtailment is less than a month, mileage allowance may be allowed at the discretion of the recalling authority.

Rule 146. No TA After Retirement / Dismissal

Unless otherwise expressly provided, no person is entitled to TA for a journey made after retirement, dismissal, or termination of service.

5. TA on Retirement (Rule 147)

A Competent Authority may, for recorded special reasons, permit a retiring Government servant to draw TA for a journey of the kind in Rule 146.

TA on retirement is NOT admissible to:

- (a) those who quit service by resignation;
- (b) those dismissed or removed from service;
- (c) those compulsorily retired as a measure of punishment; and
- (d) temporary employees with less than **10 years** of service retiring on superannuation / invalidation / on being retrenched.

Four Components of TA on Retirement

1. Travel entitlement for self and family (general conditions of SR 147 continue to apply).
2. Composite Transfer & Packing Grant (CTG) — **80% of last month's basic pay** for those settling at a place other than the last station of duty (subject to actual change of residence, with a self-declaration certificate); **100%** for settlement to/from the A&N Islands and Lakshadweep. NPA and MSP are excluded. Transfer incidentals and road mileage between residence and station are subsumed in the CTG.
3. Reimbursement of charges for transportation of personal effects (conditions and rates as on transfer).
4. Reimbursement of charges for transportation of conveyance (conditions and rates as on transfer).

Government Decisions on Retirement TA

- (1) TA for journeys to attend a departmental enquiry after removal / dismissal / compulsory retirement, where a further / de novo enquiry is ordered and the Government servant is required to attend.
- (2) TA for a retired Government servant for attending a departmental enquiry / judicial proceedings against him — under SR 153-A.
- (3) No advance of TA is granted for journeys performed after retirement.

6. TA to the Family of a Deceased Government Servant

Rule 148. TA to the Family

A Competent Authority may grant such TA as it deems fit to the family of a Government servant who dies while in service.

- (1) Conveyance, at Government expense, of the family and personal effects of a Government servant who dies in service.
- (2) The journey must be completed within **one year** after the death.
- (3) The one-year time limit may be extended with the approval of the Financial Adviser of the Ministry concerned.

To whom payable & procedure:

- (i) the surviving widow (or the eldest among them) if the deceased was a male officer, or the husband if the deceased was a female officer;
- (ii) the eldest surviving (dependent) child, provided he/she has attained majority; or
- (iii) any person whom the Head of Office considers fit to receive payment on behalf of a minor, subject to a bond with two sureties indemnifying Government against subsequent claims.
- (4) The amount is drawn on a TA bill (TR-25) by the Head of Office under whom the deceased last served.
- (5) The bond is preserved for **7 years** after the year of payment.
- (6) An advance to meet travelling expenses (limited to the probable amount) is admissible to only one member of the family.

7. TA to a Government Servant Under Suspension / Attending Court

Rule 153-A. TA for a Departmental Enquiry

A Government servant under suspension required to attend a departmental enquiry may be allowed TA as for a journey on tour, from his headquarters to the place of enquiry, OR from the place where he has been permitted to reside during suspension to the place of enquiry, whichever is less. No TA is admissible if the enquiry is held at an outstation at his own request. His TA is regulated by the grade to which he belonged prior to suspension.

Government Decisions under SR 153-A

- (1) TA for appearing before the police or a court.
- (2) TA for journeys for perusal of documents — maximum 3 days — subject to the prescribed certificates from the Inquiring Officer, the competent authority, and the Head of Office.
- (3) Change of headquarters during suspension — TA is admissible where the competent authority makes the change in the public interest.
- (4) Grant of TA advance while under suspension for attending an inquiry outside headquarters.

Rule 154. TA for Giving Evidence

These provisions apply to a Government servant summoned to give evidence in a criminal case, a case before a court-martial, a civil case to which Government is a party, or a departmental inquiry, provided the facts came to his knowledge in the discharge of his public duties:

- He may draw TA as for a journey on tour, attaching a certificate of attendance from the court / authority. When he draws such TA, he may not accept payment of expenses from the court; any fees deposited in the court for his TA / subsistence must be credited to Government.
- If the court is within 8 km of his headquarters (so no TA is admissible) and he is not in receipt of permanent TA, he may accept such payment of actual travelling expenses as the court may make.

Treatment of periods spent in attending courts

- (a) To give evidence on facts known in the discharge of public duties — the period is treated as duty.
- (b) To depose on facts known in a private capacity — the period is treated as casual / ordinary leave, as admissible; no special leave is granted.
- (c) Attending court as a juror or assessor (with the permission of the Head of Department) — the period is treated as special leave.

Rule 157 & 157-A. TA for Medical Certificate / Medical Board

A Government servant stationed where there is no Government medical officer, who is required to obtain a medical certificate from a Government Medical Officer, may draw TA for the journey to obtain that certificate.

- (1) TA is admissible for a journey to obtain a medical certificate in support of an application for an ORIGINAL grant of leave, but NOT for an extension of leave.
- (2) No TA for obtaining a fitness certificate.
- (3) No TA for procuring a health certificate on first appointment.
- (4) TA / DA as on tour is admissible for journeys and halts connected with a second medical opinion by a competent authority, with a maximum daily allowance for **two days**.
- Rule 157-A — a Government servant required to appear before a medical board, or before a nominated medical officer for further opinion on the necessity of recommended leave, may draw TA for that journey. (TA is NOT admissible for a second medical opinion in support of an EXTENSION of leave.)

Rule 164. TA for Training

Where a Government servant (or a student not already in Government service) is selected to undergo a course of training, a competent authority may decide the scale for the purpose of TA.

Chapter VI — Controlling Officers

Rule 191. Declaration of Controlling Officer

A competent authority declares which authority is the Controlling Officer for TA purposes for each Government servant / class of servants, and may declare that a particular Government servant is his own Controlling Officer.

- (1) Own Controlling Officer — all officers of the rank of Under Secretary and above may be declared their own Controlling Officer.
- (2) In other cases — for non-gazetted / gazetted staff below the rank of Under Secretary, the Under Secretary concerned may be the Controlling Officer.

Rule 192 & 194. Countersignature

- Rule 192 — no TA bill (other than permanent TA) is paid unless signed or countersigned by the Controlling Officer of the Government servant presenting it.
- Rule 194 — the duty of countersignature may be delegated to subordinates.

Rule 194-A. Time-Bar on TA Claims

The right to TA (including daily allowance) is forfeited, or deemed relinquished, if the claim is not preferred within **sixty days** from the date it became due.

Rule 195. Duties of the Controlling Officer

Before signing / countersigning a TA bill, the Controlling Officer must:

- (a) scrutinise the necessity, frequency and duration of journeys and halts, and disallow any TA for a journey he considers unnecessary or unduly protracted, or for a halt of excessive duration;
- (b) scrutinise carefully the distances entered;
- (c) satisfy himself that mileage for rail / steamer journeys has been claimed at the rate for the class actually used, and that concessional return tickets were purchased wherever possible; and
- (d) satisfy himself that the scale on which personal effects / servants were transported (where the actual cost is claimed) was reasonable, and disallow any unreasonable claim.

Date on which a TA claim falls due

(a) Tour / journey — the date succeeding the date of completion of the journey.

(b) Transfer — the date succeeding the date of completion of the journey (NOT the date of assumption of charge at the new station).

Time-Limit for Submission of TA Claims

Type of claim	Time-limit
With advance — Tour / Transfer / Training	15 days
Without advance — Tour / Transfer / Training	60 days
On Retirement	180 days from the date succeeding completion of the journey

Exam pointers — TA Rules

Entitlements are by Pay Level, not pay band, since 01.07.2017. NPA is excluded from “pay in the level”.

CTG = 80% of last basic pay (100% for islands); 1/3 for transfer < 20 km within the same city; NPA & MSP excluded.

DA on tour: >12 hrs = 100%, 6–12 hrs = 70%, <6 hrs = 30%. Local journey halves these (50% / 35% / 15%).

TA claim time-bar (Rule 194-A): 60 days. On retirement: 180 days. With advance: 15 days.

Conveyance allowance needs >200 km average monthly running; not for bicycle journeys.

PART D — DEARNESS ALLOWANCE, DEARNESS RELIEF & HOUSE RENT ALLOWANCE

This Part covers three of the most frequently-tested allowances: **Dearness Allowance (DA)** for serving employees, **Dearness Relief (DR)** for pensioners, and **House Rent Allowance (HRA)**. DA is revised twice a year (with effect from 1st January and 1st July) on the basis of the All-India Consumer Price Index for Industrial Workers (AICPI-IW).

Current DA / DR — verified

DA / DR stands at 60% of basic pay / pension with effect from 01.01.2026.

Authority: Ministry of Finance, Department of Expenditure OM No. 1/1(i)/2026-E.II(B) dated 22.04.2026 (DA raised from 58% to 60%).

1. Dearness Allowance (D.A.)

Basis of calculation: DA is calculated on Basic Pay + NPA (Non-Practising Allowance, where admissible).

Under suspension: DA is calculated on the Subsistence Allowance.

Leave / joining time: DA is admissible during leave and joining time, except during Extraordinary Leave (EOL).

Deputation abroad: DA is admissible, except that it is not drawn in conjunction with Foreign Allowance — where an official posted abroad draws Foreign Allowance under MEA terms, that allowance substitutes for Indian DA / HRA for the period abroad.

State Government servant on deputation to the Central Government — DA is regulated by either:

- Option (i): pay of the post in the Central Government + DA admissible under Central rules; OR
- Option (ii): (pay in the State Government + Deputation Allowance) of the State Government + DA admissible under State Government rules.

Foreign service: DA is subject to the sanctioned terms of appointment; the Government servant may draw it on the basis of his pay in foreign service.

Rounding of fraction: a fraction of 50 paise and above is rounded up to the next higher rupee; a fraction of less than 50 paise is ignored.

2. Dearness Relief (D.R.)

Basis of calculation: DR is calculated on the original Pension / Family Pension (before commutation).

Re-employed pensioners: DR is also admissible.

Provisional pension: the Head of Office should pay relief on pension along with the provisional pension.

Pensioners residing abroad: those drawing pension in foreign currency are eligible for DR.

CPF beneficiaries: the families of CPF beneficiaries are entitled to DR on the ex-gratia payment.

Rounding of fraction: any fraction of a rupee in the amount of DR is rounded up to the next higher rupee.

3. House Rent Allowance (H.R.A.)

3.1 Current Rates of HRA (on Basic Pay only)

City class	Population criteria	HRA rate
X	50 lakh and above	30%
Y	5 lakh to 50 lakh	20%
Z	Below 5 lakh	10%

How the current rates arose — verified

The 7th CPC fixed HRA at 24% / 16% / 8% (X/Y/Z) from 01.07.2017, with two automatic step-ups built in:

- when DA crosses 25% → 27% / 18% / 9% (effective 01.07.2021); and
- when DA crosses 50% → 30% / 20% / 10% (effective 01.01.2024).

Since DA crossed 50% w.e.f. 01.01.2024, the present rates are 30% / 20% / 10%. DA stands at 60% as on 01.01.2026, so the second slab continues to apply. The 30/20/10 figures are the second revision step of the same OM, not a fresh substitution of 24/16/8.

Authority: MoF, DoE OM No. 2/5/2017-E.II(B) dated 07.07.2017, read with the allowance-revision OM dated 12.04.2024.

Minimum floor: HRA shall not be less than Rs. 5,400, Rs. 3,600 and Rs. 1,800 per month for X, Y and Z class cities respectively (these floors equal 30% / 20% / 10% of the minimum pay of Rs. 18,000).

Meaning of Basic Pay: HRA is calculated on Basic Pay under FR 9(21)(a)(i) only — it does NOT include NPA, MSP, special pay or any other type of pay.

3.2 Definitions

“Pay” means pay as defined in FR 9(21)(a).

“Family” means a Government servant's wife / husband, children, and other persons residing with and wholly dependent upon him / her.

Dependency income limit: a husband / wife / child / parent having an independent source of income is NOT treated as a family member, except where such income — including pension (with TI on pension and the pension-equivalent of DCRG benefits) — does not exceed Rs. 9,000 per month.

Note

The dependency income limit is Rs. 9,000 per month (income inclusive of pension + TI on pension). The figure Rs. 9,000 already reflects the revised minimum pension under the 7th CPC.

3.3 Admissibility of HRA

Reference point: HRA is admissible with reference to the “Place of Duty”, irrespective of whether the Government servant resides at that place or elsewhere.

No NAC needed: HRA is admissible where Government accommodation is not availed. The condition of applying for accommodation and furnishing a “No Accommodation Certificate” has been dispensed with for GPRA (DoE OM dated 05.03.2019).

- Not admissible to those who occupy Government accommodation, or who were offered it but refused it.

Effect of refusal: a refusal debars the servant from further allotment for one year; HRA is not admissible during the debarment.

On acceptance: HRA is stopped from the date of actual hand-over of accommodation in an immediately habitable condition.

On refusal of allotment: HRA ceases from the date of allotment.

On surrender: HRA is again payable from the date of surrender of the accommodation.

Deemed possession: if, after acceptance, the servant fails to take possession within 8 days of receipt of the allotment letter, licence fee is charged for up to 12 days (deemed possession), and NO HRA is admissible for that 12-day period [SR 317-B-12(1)].

Sub-letting / breach: a servant debarred from allotment due to unauthorised sub-letting or breach of allotment rules is NOT admissible to HRA during the debarment period.

- HRA is NOT admissible if the servant stays in Inspection Quarters.
- A servant is not entitled to HRA if sharing Government accommodation allotted to another Government servant. Where two or more related Government servants share, HRA is admissible to only one of them, at their choice.

Relative's allotted accommodation: HRA is not admissible if the servant resides in accommodation allotted to parents / son / daughter / spouse (spouse: same station) by the Central Govt. / State Govt. / PSU / Autonomous body / LIC / Port Trust / nationalised bank / semi-government organisation such as a municipality.

Both spouses in Government service: both husband and wife are entitled to HRA separately if living in hired / owned accommodation.

Self-owned house: a servant living in a house owned by self, spouse, children, father or mother is also eligible for HRA.

4. HRA on Transfer

Retention of old accommodation: a servant who, on transfer, retains Government accommodation at the old station (on normal / penal / market rent) is entitled to HRA at the new station for up to 8 months from the date of transfer.

Family left behind (no Government accommodation at the old station) – HRA is regulated as below:

Period	Rate of HRA
First 2 months from joining at the new station	Same rate as drawn at the old station
Next 4 months, or end of academic year, whichever is later	Old-station rate OR maximum admissible at the new station, whichever is less

Temporary transfer up to 90 days: HRA continues at the old-station rate. If the temporary transfer exceeds 90 days, HRA is regulated with reference to the new place of posting (from the date of the order extending it beyond 90 days).

Special areas: double the rate of HRA applies for employees posted in the N-E Region, A&N Islands and Lakshadweep, etc.

5. HRA During Leave

General rule: HRA is drawn during leave at the same rate as before proceeding on leave. "Leave" means total leave of all kinds (including CCL) not exceeding 180 days.

LPR: admissible during Leave Preparatory to Retirement, subject to a certificate that the employee and/or family continues to reside at the same station.

Death / invalidation: if the servant does not rejoin after leave (medical or otherwise) owing to death or invalidation, HRA already drawn need NOT be recovered.

Resignation after leave: if the servant does not rejoin and resigns, the entire HRA is recovered before the resignation is accepted.

Extension for serious illness: the 180-day limit extends to 8 months if the servant suffers from TB, cancer or other specified ailments; beyond 8 months is decided by the controlling authority.

After foreign service: HRA is not admissible for leave immediately on termination of foreign service before resuming duty under Government.

During CCL: admissible for the first 180 days; beyond 180 days on furnishing the prescribed certificate.

Industrial employees (CCS Leave Rules, 1972): HRA admissible for the first 40 days of leave; extended up to 180 days if suffering from TB / cancer / other ailments during leave, on medical certificate.

6. HRA During Joining Time

During joining time, the servant continues to draw HRA at the same rate as at the station from which transferred.

7. HRA on Deputation Abroad

Up to 1 year: HRA is admissible for the entire period of deputation.

Exceeding 1 year: HRA is admissible provided the family remains at the last place of duty in India.

8. HRA During Training

Training Abroad

- A servant deputed for training abroad is entitled to HRA based on the station from which deputed, on production of the prescribed certificate.
- HRA is admissible up to 6 months of leave (if taken) from the completion of training.

Training in India

- A servant (permanent or temporary) sent on training in India, whose training period is treated as duty under FR 9(6)(b), is entitled to HRA for the entire training period.

9. HRA During Suspension

Drawal: HRA during suspension is regulated under FR 53(1)(ii)(b) and FR 54, subject to the prescribed certificate for periods beyond 180 days. HRA (and CCA) is computed on the basis of the pay the servant was drawing on the date of suspension, subject to a certificate that he/she continues to incur the expenditure.

Important distinction

Only DA is computed on the subsistence allowance. HRA is NOT — it is computed on the pay drawn on the date of suspension.

Change of HQ: if the headquarters of a suspended servant is changed in the public interest by the competent authority, entitlement shifts to the HRA of the new station.

10. Re-employed Pensioners

A re-employed pensioner is treated as a fresh appointment in the department for the purpose of allowance calculation.

Quick-Revision Ready Reckoner — DA / DR / HRA

Item	Key figure / rule
DA rounding	≥ 50 paise $\rightarrow$ round up; < 50 paise $\rightarrow$ ignore
DR rounding	Any fraction of a rupee $\rightarrow$ always round up
DA base	Basic Pay + NPA
DR base	Original pension / family pension (before commutation)
HRA rates (current)	30% / 20% / 10% (X/Y/Z) — DA crossed 50% w.e.f. 01.01.2024
HRA minimum floor	Rs. 5,400 / 3,600 / 1,800
HRA base	Basic Pay [FR 9(21)(a)(i)] — excludes NPA, MSP, special pay
Dependency income limit	Rs. 9,000 / month (incl. pension + TI)
Deemed possession	Fail to occupy within 8 days $\rightarrow$ no HRA for 12 days
Refusal $\rightarrow$ debarment	1 year; no HRA during debarment
HRA on transfer (retention)	Up to 8 months
Family left behind	First 2 months: old rate; next 4 months / end of academic year: lower of the two
Temporary transfer	≤ 90 days: old rate; > 90 days: new posting
HRA during leave	Up to 180 days; 8 months if TB / cancer etc.
HRA during CCL	First 180 days; beyond, on certificate
Industrial employees	40 days; up to 180 days for TB / cancer on MC
Suspension HRA	On pay at date of suspension (only DA on subsistence allowance)

Exam pointers — DA / DR / HRA

DA base = Basic + NPA; DR base = original pension. HRA base = Basic Pay only (no NPA / MSP / special pay).

HRA 30/20/10% is current because DA crossed 50% (01.01.2024); minimum floors Rs. 5,400 / 3,600 / 1,800.

Under suspension: DA on subsistence allowance, but HRA on pay drawn at the date of suspension.

Deemed possession: fail to occupy within 8 days $\rightarrow$ no HRA for 12 days. Refusal $\rightarrow$ 1-year debarment, no HRA.

— End of Study Material —

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